ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	44th Commission Meeting
DATE:	09 September, 2021
TIME:	09:30 am
VENUE:	Hearing Room

#	AGENDA	DECISIONS
1	**Update on the Research programs**	As an introductory note, the Chief Research Officer presented the highlights of the research proposals, activities, and budget for (FY 2021-2022) and strategies for field work considering the CoVID-19 pandemic. He submitted that the presentation of proposals is to seek advices and endorsement to carry out the activities in absence of research committee and the urgency to complete fieldwork at the earliest possible owing to the pandemic situation.
2	**Presentation of Proposal to Review and Evaluate Social Accountability Program**	Kezang Tshering, Sr. Research Officer, presented on Proposal to Review and Evaluate Social Accountability Program to the Commission. **Comments and Feedback from the Commission** 2.1 The commission directed the Research Division to also review and analyze how the participatory approach is used as a process in local governance particularly in terms of budget allocation and utilization. The research team should also explore analysis of the following to augment the methods proposed: a) Parliamentary debate and discussions on Local Government issues; b) Audit Observations issued by the Royal Audit Authority; c) Minutes of *Dzongkhag Tshogdu* and *Gewog Tshogde;* d) *Complaints received by ACC against LG;* e) Disciplinary Actions; and f) Mainstream media reports. 2.2 Regarding the main evaluation question, the commission shared that the *'Local Government'* in the research question should be replaced by *'Local Governance'* as the former refers to an authority to govern and the latter encompasses the action or manner of governing, given the scope of the study.

		2.3 The commission advised that the overarching goal of the evaluation should be behavioral change in the society and this evaluation should provide empirical insights for behavioral change for public officials and citizens at the LG level.
3	**Presentation of Proposal for the Youth Integrity Survey.**	Kinzang Gyeltshen, Research Officer presented the proposal for Youth Integrity Survey: What do young Bhutanese think about integrity? **Comments and Feedback from the Commission** 3.1 The commission shared that the research title 'Youth Integrity Survey: What do young Bhutanese think about integrity?' should also encompass the actions of youth in addition to what they think. 3.2 The commission recommended to include the following aspects; a) Discipline and behavioral change as an overarching goal of the assessment. b) Roles of government, education system and the society (CSOs and citizens) as a whole in addition to parents and teachers in inculcating integrity for youth; c) Role of SUPW: how can we leverage/enhance this program to promote integrity? What needs to be done to relate this to integrity?; d) Ethics as one of the components for assessment in the survey; e) Employed youth and their supervisors, monks and nuns as one of the strata for sampling. f) Of the two proposals for analysis, the Commission advised to carry out indexing and emphasized the need to carry out the study at least once in a five-year plan. Accordingly, the study will be 'Youth Integrity Assessment' instead of "Youth Integrity Survey".
4	**Presentation of plans for 5th National Integrity Assessment, and the Ethical Leadership Survey.**	Shacha Wangchuk, Assistant Research Officer presented the key activities on the Preparation of the 5th National Integrity Assessment, and the Conduct of Ethical Leadership Survey. **Comments and Feedback from the Commission** 4.1 The commission recommended the Division to consult the Commission and key stakeholders while developing a questionnaire for parliamentarians and to explore the possibilities of assessment of both the elected and administrative Local Government officials in this year's assessment. 4.2 The team was advised to develop a comprehensive consultation programs to develop and finalize the questionnaire

		for assessment of parliamentarians.
5	**Others**	**General Comments and Feedback from the Commission** The commission approved the overall program and activities as planned. However, the research team should consider the following: 5.1 the overarching goal for the studies should be to bring societal behavior change through enhancing integrity (Damtsi) and discipline; 5.2 to complete field work by mid of November 2021 considering the upcoming Local Government elections; 5.3 procure additional mobile tablets to replace the few old and non-functional one from the budget savings; 5.4 expedite the tasks so that the preliminary findings are ready before the budget notice in February and March 2022; and 5.5 include officials from the key stakeholders as supervisors if officials of ACC are not available.

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**